

RICO GARCIA

ROLE : Principal Product Manager

DOMAINS : 0-to-1 products, AI, Data, Product Discovery, EdTech

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EXPERIENCE

[01] PRINCIPAL PRODUCT MANAGER

JAN 2026 - PRESENT

MAGPIE LITERACY / NEW YORK, NY

3-PHASE REPLATFORM

K-2 > K-8 EXPANSION

GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE

Own Platform Data for a K-8 reading application: data infrastructure, internal analytics, and educator-facing dashboards. Sole PM leading a new team through a full replatform, trust restoration, and K-2 to K-8 expansion.

- + Led a three-phase replatform from monolithic ETL to a governed data lake (dbt, CI/CD, Postgres-served marts), removing the scaling and data-consistency constraints blocking growth while the product stayed live.
- + Migrated the faultiest dashboard via a controlled, time-boxed blackout, establishing the no-downtime playbook for later phases.
- + Built the discovery program grounding the roadmap: surveys, competitor analysis, in-person interviews, and classroom site visits.
- + Established first Product/Research data governance (shared definitions, lineage docs, BI tool) and stood up observability from zero: usage reporting, SLI/SLOs, DataDog alerting.
- + Shipped an unplanned assessment scoring rework against a hard back-to-school deadline; led cross-team data deletion compliant with FERPA, COPPA, GDPR, and NY2D.
- + Solo-shipped the first published Platform roadmap, a nine-video educator enablement series, and a self-built WCAG 2.2 compliance scanner.

[02] SENIOR AI PRODUCT MANAGER

JAN 2025 - JAN 2026

SAFERDATA LABS / NEW YORK, NY

MVP / 90 DAYS

97% EVAL ALIGNMENT

4 PILOTS

Product discovery and market validation for a stealth MIT startup building an AI foundation model for structured data, targeting U.S. financial markets.

- + Delivered MVP in 90 days with a lean team; secured 4 pilot commitments and 5 follow-on engagements.
- + Built MCP-powered demo prototype achieving 97% alignment in evaluation tests across segmentation and probability modes.
- + Achieved 4.5/5 or higher demo feedback and 100% feature request submission, validating usability and feeding the roadmap.
- + Conducted fintech and embedded banking market analyses to define product opportunities and intersection points.
- + Acquired training data, ran structured LLM evaluations, and developed testing methods for accuracy and explainability.

[03] PRODUCT MANAGER

JAN 2023 - JAN 2025

INSTRUCTURE INC. (CANVAS LMS) / NEW YORK, NY

+\$2M YEAR 1

+102% LISTINGS

+65% MAU

End-to-end product strategy and execution across multiple business lines at a global EdTech leader.

- + Owned creation of a new EdTech Marketplace consolidating legacy sources into one catalog: +102% listings in 5 months, +\$2M first-year revenue, 95% positive user sentiment.
- + Built and launched 5 new product offerings across 3 engineering teams; sunset 2 legacy products.
- + Led Partner Portal development: +65% MAU and +75% total accounts in 5 months, surpassing OKR KPIs; 8 new features became the most-used in the application.
- + Created LTI configuration experience driving +43% provider-published assets in 7 months.
- + Consolidated 3 repositories, cutting 20+ hrs/week of maintenance and eliminating end-user drop-off.

[04] **PRODUCT MANAGER**

JAN 2022 - JAN 2023

LEARNPLATFORM INC. / NEW YORK, NY

TTV: 14 DAYS > 0 ~3,000 TAGS / 90 DAYS

- + Developed Customer Created Product feature, eliminating ~330 contractor hours and cutting Time-to-Value from 14 days to immediate.
- + Owned LearnCommunity asset library roadmap; automation added ~3,000 validated metadata tags in 90 days, making it the largest U.S. EdTech repository for privacy, interoperability, efficacy, and compliance.
- + Built branching offline demo prototypes and produced video media for marketing, support, and sales enablement.
- + Delivered national webinars and RFI/RFP responses; sole product expert enabling the Growth Team.

[05] **DIRECTOR OF EDUCATION PARTNERSHIPS**

NOV 2019 - JAN 2022

AGILE MIND / NEW YORK, NY

1 > 29 PARTNERSHIPS +\$700K / 2020

- + Expanded +90% of all partnerships while achieving quarterly retention and expansion quotas.
- + Grew NYC tier 1 white space from 1 to 29 partnerships in the first year (+\$300K).
- + Landed the largest new partnerships in Massachusetts and New Jersey: +\$700K revenue in 2020.

[06] **REGIONAL EDUCATION PARTNERSHIPS MANAGER**

JUN 2016 - OCT 2019

DISCOVERY COMMUNICATIONS / NEW YORK, NY

\$8.4M VS \$7.4M TARGET

- + Achieved \$8.4M credited revenue against a \$7.4M team target.
- + Built a personal pipeline exceeding \$3M in year one and \$6M in year two.
- + Launched three new EdTech products with the go-to-market team.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

VP of Marketing & Sales / Downtown Norfolk Entertainment / 2012-2016

Owned 100% of revenue; delivered \$730K first-year new category revenue against a \$296K target (+140%); led full rebrand.

Resource & Development Manager / The AIDS Fund / 2009-2011

Helped grow funding to a record \$6M, the largest AIDS nonprofit in Hampton Roads, VA; generated \$3M in sponsor and government contracts.

SYSTEMS / STACK

LANGUAGES	JavaScript / React / Node / Express / SQL / HTML / CSS
DATA + AI	dbt / Postgres / CI-CD / DataDog / MCP / LLM evaluation / LLM tooling (Claude Code, LibreChat) / Warp / Mongo Atlas
TOOLS	Figma / Pendo / GitHub / Heroku / Railway / Bolt / Navattic / CRM ecosystems / Diagramming & whiteboarding (Miro, Lucid) / Video production

EDUCATION

Columbia University	Full Stack Software Engineering Certificate	2021-2022
Old Dominion University	Communications	2010-2012
Tidewater Community College	Associate Degree	2008-2010